

29 May 2003

Dear Jen,

It has been a few days since I last wrote but not too much has changed. The days of action and excitement seem to be gone, replaced by a slow and steady routine. Looking back on it all, the lawlessness of war is somewhat exciting. I just need a different role to play in all of this. I hope that everything is going well at home; I have not received a letter in some time.

Over the past few days things have been pretty boring around here. Each night is marked by one incident followed by complete peace and quiet. The other day, one of Bounty's patrols was driving through a local market when a grenade was thrown at them. The company responded in force, blocking off both exits and sending dismounted patrols to comb through the street. One man was arrested when the tankers at a checkpoint found a grenade in his car. We don't know if he was involved in the incident, but that was close enough.

Perhaps the funniest thing about the incident occurred at one of the checkpoints blocking the road. One Iraqi man ran into the back of another car. The guy in the first car got out of the car and began yelling at the man in the car that had just ran into him. I guess the second guy didn't like being yelled at so he got out of his car, pulled out a pistol and shot the first dude in the leg. That's Iraq for you! This place is filled with a bunch of crazy mother-fuckers.

I have been hooked on "Panzer General." I am a German Tank Commander and lead various assaults on allied forces. I must be the greatest military mind in history since I have managed to capture Norway, drive the British from Africa and the Middle East, and am now on the gates of Moscow. I imagine that I will be invading England pretty soon—but you probably don't care too much about that.

I did make an excellent discovery today. Some of the Headquarters' tankers have built a gym, complete with bench press and dumbbells. I have not worked out in so long that its almost scary to start again. Thankfully we have no idea how much any of the weights weigh so my ego won't be hurt too badly. I will start lifting everyday. The gym is quite innovative. The bench press is welded together using old bed springs, and the weights themselves are made of different cogs and sprockets from our maintenance platoon. Tank parts are pretty heavy so it works well. I will keep you updated on how it goes.

Otherwise it has been a slow news day here. The only significant event was when a Sergeant in one of our companies was outright rude to me on the radio. I called him and told him that I wanted to see him at the Battalion TOC right away. I delivered a quick, yet effective admonishment and went about my business. Again, hope you are doing well and I can't wait to get home.

Love,



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